
HEOKA

The AI Company Brain Starter Kit

Stop explaining your business to your AI every morning.
Thirty minutes, using the subscription you already pay for.

Version 2

What is in here

Guide	What it covers
1. Start Here	Thirty minutes from nothing to a working setup, using the AI you already pay for.
2. Your Company Brain	The folder, the MASTER file, and every page template. Twenty minutes to a brain worth asking questions of.
3. Your Skills	Nine named jobs you can hand to ChatGPT or Claude. Install once, use for years.
4. Running It Weekly	Two minutes a day, twenty minutes a week, an hour a month. The habit that decides whether this still works in six months.
5. When Your Data Cannot Leave	The day cloud AI stops being fine, what your options actually are, and how much they cost.

This is the reading copy. The kit also includes a ready-made folder you open in Obsidian, with every template already filled in with an example. Start there if you would rather do than read.

One rule throughout: no passwords, no bank details, no card numbers, ever. Those belong in a password manager.

Start Here

Thirty minutes from nothing to a working setup, using the AI you already pay for.

You already pay for ChatGPT or Claude. You already use it most days. And you have probably noticed the same thing everyone notices after a few months: it is brilliant in the moment and useless the next morning. You explain your business again. You paste the same background again. You get a good answer, close the tab, and it is gone.

That is not a problem with the AI. It is a problem with the setup around it. This kit is the setup.

What this actually is

Two things, and neither of them is software you have to buy.

A company brain. One folder of plain files on your computer holding what your business knows: your clients, your projects, your prices, your decisions, your meeting notes. You read and write it in a free app called Obsidian.

A set of skills. Nine named jobs you can hand to ChatGPT or Claude, written out in full, ready to copy and paste. Things like "write up my week", "onboard a new client", "draft the chase email", "turn these meeting notes into actions". You install them once and use them for years.

Put together, you stop chatting with AI and start running your business through it. You paste in the file, you run the skill, you get the same quality of output every time, because the instructions are the same every time.

What you need

- **Obsidian.** Free, from obsidian.md. Free for business use too. This is the only thing you install.
- **The AI subscription you already have.** ChatGPT Plus or Claude Pro, either is fine. Both work. You do not need a new one.
- **Thirty minutes.** Genuinely. Set a timer.

That is the whole list. No new subscription, no coding, no plugins, no accounts to create.

Your files are yours

Everything you write lives in ordinary text files in a folder on your own computer. Not in a database. Not in someone's app. Not behind a login.

That matters more than it sounds. If Obsidian disappeared tomorrow, your files would still open in Notes, Word, TextEdit, or anything else with a cursor. If you switch computers, you copy a folder. If you want to back it up, you back up a folder. There is no export button because there is nothing to export from. In thirty years those files will still open.

Most business software rents you access to your own information. This does not.

What you will have in thirty minutes

- A folder on your computer with eight labelled sections, ready to fill.
- One MASTER file that tells the AI who your business is, so you never explain it again.
- Your most important client written down properly, in one page.
- Your first skill installed and run, on real work, with a real answer back.

The thirty minutes

Time	What you do	Where
0 to 5	Install Obsidian, create the folder	01_Your_Company_Brain
5 to 20	Write the MASTER file and one client page	01_Your_Company_Brain
20 to 30	Install and run your first skill	02_Your_Skills

Then read `03_Running_It_Weekly.md` when you have a spare ten minutes. That one is about the habit, and the habit is what decides whether this is still working in six months or sitting in your downloads folder.

The five files in this kit

1. **00_START_HERE.md** (this one). What it is and how the thirty minutes go.
2. **01_Your_Company_Brain.md**. The folder structure, the MASTER file, and every page template you need.
3. **02_Your_Skills.md**. The nine skills. This is the part you will use every week.
4. **03_Running_It_Weekly.md**. Daily two minutes, weekly twenty, monthly hour.
5. **04_When_Your_Data_Cant_Leave.md**. For the day a client asks where their information goes. Read it before that day, not after.

Be honest about one thing first

This works if you write things down. It is not magic and it does not read your mind. The AI can only be as good as what you show it, and what you show it is what you wrote last week.

The good news is that the writing is small. Three bullets after a call. Two lines when you decide something. Five minutes on a Friday. The kit is built so that small amounts of writing produce large amounts of use.

Do this now

Go to `obsidian.md`, download it, and install it. That is it for this file. Two minutes. Then open `01_Your_Company_Brain.md` and keep going.

Your Company Brain

The folder, the MASTER file, and every page template. Twenty minutes to a brain worth asking questions of.

Your company brain is one folder of plain files. That is the whole trick. No database, no subscription, no export problem.

Obsidian is the free app you use to read and write those files. It does not store anything itself. It just gives you a nice window onto a folder that already exists on your computer. You could delete Obsidian tomorrow and every file would still be sitting there, readable in any app you own.

This is the part of the kit that takes twenty minutes. Do it once, add to it as you go.

Step one: make the folder

1. Download Obsidian from [obsidian.md](#) and install it. On a Mac, drag it into Applications. On Windows, run the installer.
2. Open it and choose **Create new vault**. "Vault" is just Obsidian's word for folder.
3. Name it CompanyBrain. One word, no spaces.
4. Put it somewhere obvious and shallow, like your home folder or Documents. Not five levels deep.
5. Click Create. You are looking at an empty folder.

Step two: make eight sections

In the left sidebar, right-click and choose **New folder**. Make these eight, exactly as written including the numbers:

```
00_System
01_Company
02_Active_Projects
03_Clients
04_Finance_Admin
05_Skills
06_Meetings
99_Archive
```

The numbers are not decoration. They force the folders to always sort in the same order, in Obsidian and in Finder and in anything you point at the folder later. They also tell you how often you touch each one. Low numbers are rules and facts that barely change. Middle numbers are live work. 99 is the attic.

Here is what goes where.

00_System. How your brain works. The MASTER file lives here. You write this once and touch it a few times a year.

01_Company. Facts about your business that change slowly. What you sell, what it costs, who works here, who you sell to.

02_Active_Projects. One folder per live project. A project is anything with an end: a rebuild, a launch, a big proposal.

03_Clients. One page per client. The page you would hand someone taking over the account tomorrow.

04_Finance_Admin. Renewal dates, suppliers, insurance, contract terms, recurring costs. The facts you keep looking up. Not your accounts, your accounting software does that.

05_Skills. The skills from the next file in this kit, saved so they are always one copy away.

06_Meetings. Every meeting note, named by date: 2026-07-14_Acme_Review.md. Date first, year first, so the folder sorts itself into a timeline without you doing anything.

99_Archive. Finished projects, former clients, dead documents. Move things here instead of deleting them.

One rule that matters everywhere: **no passwords, no bank details, no card numbers, ever.** Those belong in a password manager. This folder holds facts, not secrets.

Step three: the MASTER file

This is the most valuable thing in the kit. If you only do one thing on this page, do this.

Every time you open a fresh chat, the AI knows nothing about you. So you explain. Then you explain again tomorrow. The MASTER file is you writing that explanation down once, properly, so you can paste it in and be understood in three seconds.

It answers three questions: **who this business is, how it works, and what the rules are.** Everything else in the brain is detail hanging off it.

Create 00_System/MASTER.md and fill this in. Take fifteen minutes and do it honestly. Write like you are briefing a smart new employee on their first morning, including the awkward parts.

```
---
title: MASTER
description: Read this first. Who we are, how we work, and the rules.
---

# MASTER

## Who we are

- Business name:
- What we sell, in one sentence:
- Who we sell it to:
- What we charge:
- Size: (just me / me plus 3 / 12 staff)
```

```

- Where we are:
- Website:

## How we make money

- Main way we earn:
- Typical job size and length:
- Where new work comes from:
- Busiest time of year:

## How we work

- Our tone with clients: (formal, friendly, blunt, warm)
- How we prefer to communicate: (email, phone, WhatsApp)
- What good work looks like here:
- What we never do:
- Words and phrases we use:
- Words and phrases we hate:

## The people

- Me: name, role, what only I can do
- Others: name, role, what they own

## What is going on right now

- The main thing we are trying to achieve this quarter:
- The biggest problem in the business right now:
- What I am worried about:

(Update this section monthly. Everything above it changes far less often.)

## Rules for the AI

When you are helping me, follow these.

- Plain English. Short sentences. No filler and no hype words.
- Only use facts from what I have given you. If the answer is not in it, say so. Never invent a name, date, price or number.
- When you use a fact from one of my files, say which file it came from.
- Write dates as YYYY-MM-DD.
- If my request is unclear, ask me one question instead of guessing.
- Never write a password or bank detail into anything.
- Match the tone described above, not standard business writing.

```

Then, in the next file of this kit, you paste this MASTER file into ChatGPT or Claude once and it stays there permanently. That is the moment the whole thing clicks.

Keep it under two pages. A MASTER file nobody reads because it is nine pages long is worth nothing.

Step four: your first client page

Pick your most important client. Create 03_Clients/Acme_Ltd.md, using their real name in the filename, and fill this in.

Most business questions turn out to be client questions, which is why this page does more work than any other.

```
---
title: Client - Acme Ltd
description: Everything we know about Acme Ltd, in one page.
---

# Client: Acme Ltd

## Basics

- Main contact: name, role
- Other contacts:
- What they buy from us:
- Price and terms:
- Client since:
- Renewal or review date:

## How they like to work

Their communication style, preferred channel, how fast they reply,
anything that keeps the relationship smooth.

## Where things stand

- Status: healthy | needs attention | at risk
- Last contact: 2026-07-14, about what
- Open items:
  - [ ]

## History

Newest first. One line per thing that mattered.

- 2026-07-14 Quarterly review

## Risks and opportunities

-
```

Aim for honest, not complete. Blanks are fine. A half-filled page you actually use beats a perfect one you built once and never opened.

The rest of the templates

You do not need these in the first twenty minutes. Come back when the moment arrives.

A project

Make a folder in 02_Active_Projects named after the project, then put these two files inside it.

PROJECT.md:

```
---
title: PROJECT
```

```

description: What this project is and where it stands.
---

# Project: <name>

## Goal

One or two sentences. What done looks like.

## Why it matters

One paragraph maximum.

## Status

- State: not started | in progress | blocked | done
- Last updated: 2026-07-14
- Next milestone:
- Target date:

## People

- Owner:
- Also involved:

## Background

Where this came from, what constraints exist (budget, deadline,
things we must not break), and what has already been tried.

```

TASKS.md:

```

---
title: TASKS
description: Live task list for this project.
---

# Tasks: <project name>

## Now

- [ ] The single most important next action
- [ ]

## Next

- [ ]

## Waiting on

- [ ] What we are waiting for, who from, since when

## Done

- [x] 2026-07-10 Example finished task

```

Tick things off with [x] and move them down to Done rather than deleting them. The history is worth more than the tidiness.

A meeting note

Goes in 06_Meetings, named YYYY-MM-DD_Subject.md.

```
---
title: Meeting - Acme quarterly review
description: Notes from 2026-07-14.
---

# Meeting: <subject>

- Date: 2026-07-14
- Who was there:
- Client or project:

## What was discussed

Short bullets. What they said matters more than what you said.

-

## Decisions made

-

## Actions

- [ ] Action, who owns it, when by

## For next time

Anything to remember before you speak to them again.
```

A decision

Inside each project folder, make a DECISIONS folder. One file per decision, named by date: 2026-07-14_switched_supplier.md.

Decisions are the most valuable thing you will ever put in here. Six months from now, "why on earth did we do it that way" is the question you will ask most, and it is the one nobody can answer.

```
---
title: Decision - switched supplier
description: Why we switched and what else we looked at.
---

# Decision: <short title>

- Date: 2026-07-14
- Decided by:
- Status: decided | revisit on <date>

## What we decided

One or two sentences.

## Why
```

The real reasons, in plain language.

What we said no to

- Option B, because:
- Option C, because:

What this commits us to

What we would have to undo if we changed our mind.

Recurring costs

04_Finance_Admin/Recurring_Costs.md. Fill it once, thank yourself every quarter.

```
---
title: Recurring Costs
description: Every subscription and recurring supplier cost.
---

# Recurring Costs

| Item | Supplier | Cost | Billing | Renewal date | Notice needed |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Accounting software | | £/mo | Monthly | | 30 days |
| Insurance | | £/yr | Annual | | |
```

Three naming habits

These three make the difference between a folder you can search and a folder you avoid opening.

1. **Dates first, year first.** 2026-07-14_Acme_Review.md sorts itself. Acme review July.md does not.
2. **Underscores instead of spaces.** Acme_Ltd.md, not Acme Ltd.md. Spaces cause trouble in places you cannot predict, and underscores never do.
3. **One subject per page.** A page called Acme_Ltd.md holding everything about Acme is good. A page called Misc.md is where information goes to die.

Do this now

Open Obsidian, create 00_System/MASTER.md, and fill in the first section only: who you are, what you sell, who you sell it to, what you charge. Four lines. Everything else can wait until this evening, but those four lines are what makes the next file work.

Your Skills

Nine named jobs you can hand to ChatGPT or Claude. Install once, use for years.

A skill is a job with a name.

Not a clever prompt you wrote at 11pm and never found again. A named, written-down job that produces the same quality of output every single time you run it, because the instructions are identical every time you run it. "Weekly Review." "Chase Email." "Meeting Notes to Actions."

That is the difference between using AI and having AI in your business. You stop inventing the instruction each time. You just pick the job.

There are nine here. You will probably use four of them constantly and the others when the moment comes. Start with one.

How to install them

Do this bit first. It takes five minutes and everything afterwards is easier.

If you use ChatGPT

The one thing to do: set up a Project.

1. In the left sidebar, click **Projects**, then **New project**. Call it your business name.
2. Open the project, find the instructions box (it may be called "Instructions" or sit behind an "Add instructions" link).
3. Paste in your whole 00_System/MASTER.md file. All of it.
4. Save.

Every chat you start inside that project now already knows who you are, how you write, and what your rules are. You never explain your business again.

Then, for each skill you want to keep: start a new chat inside the project, paste the skill, and rename the chat to the skill name. It sits in your sidebar ready to reuse. Or keep the skills in 05_Skills in your brain folder and copy from there, which is the approach that survives you switching AI tools later.

Custom Instructions (Settings, then Personalisation, then Custom Instructions) is where the short version of your MASTER file goes if you want it applied to every chat, project or not. Paste in the "How we work" and "Rules for the AI" sections. There is a length limit, so keep it to the essentials.

If you use Claude

Set up a Project.

1. Click **Projects**, then **Create project**. Name it your business name.
2. Find **Set project instructions** (sometimes shown as "Add custom instructions").

3. Paste in your whole 00_System/MASTER.md.
4. In the same project, use **Add content** to attach the files you refer to most: your client pages, your recurring costs page. Claude reads them when relevant, so you paste less.

Every chat in that project starts with your business already understood.

For the skills themselves, save each one in 05_Skills in your brain folder and paste when you need it.

Either way

Save the nine skills below as nine files in 05_Skills in your company brain. Then you own them, and they still work if you switch from ChatGPT to Claude next year or to whatever comes after.

How to run one

Every skill works the same way.

1. Open your project chat.
2. Paste the skill.
3. Paste whatever it asks for underneath, usually a file from your brain or some rough notes.
4. Send.

Where a skill says [paste . . .], that means copy the text out of the relevant page in Obsidian (click into the note, Ctrl+A or Cmd+A, then Ctrl+C or Cmd+C) and paste it in place of the bracket.

You can also attach the file instead of pasting, in either tool. Same result, fewer keystrokes.

Skill 1: Weekly Review

What it does. Reads your week's notes and tells you what actually happened, including what you dropped.

When to use it. Friday afternoon, or Monday morning if Fridays are chaos. Once a week, same slot.

Paste this:

```
You are my business assistant. Below are my notes from the past week.

Read them and give me exactly four sections, with these headings:

WINS. Up to 3 bullets. What genuinely moved.

PROBLEMS. Up to 3 bullets. What went wrong or is going wrong.

DROPPED BALLS. Anything mentioned as needing action where there is
no sign it was done. This section matters most, so be thorough
and slightly annoying about it.

NEXT WEEK. The 3 most important actions, hardest first.
```

Rules: keep every bullet under 15 words. Only use what is in my notes. If you are inferring something rather than reading it, say so.

My notes:
[paste this week's meeting notes and any daily notes]

What good output looks like. Short. Specific to your actual week, with real names and real numbers in it. The dropped balls section should make you slightly uncomfortable and contain at least one thing you had genuinely forgotten. If the output could apply to any business, your notes were too thin, not the AI.

Skill 2: Client Onboarding Runner

What it does. Turns a signed client into a full client page, a task list, and a welcome email, in one go.

When to use it. The hour after someone says yes, while you still remember what you promised them.

Paste this:

You are my business assistant. I have just won a new client. Below are my rough notes from the sales conversation.

Produce three things, clearly separated.

ONE: a client page with these exact headings: Basics, How they like to work, Where things stand, History, Risks and opportunities. Put every fact from my notes under the right heading. Where I have not given you the information, write TODO rather than guessing.

TWO: an onboarding task list for me. Every single thing that has to happen before this client is properly running, based on what I promised in my notes plus the obvious steps for this kind of work. Format as a checklist with who owns each item.

THREE: a welcome email to the client. Under 150 words. Confirms what we agreed, says what happens next and when, and asks for anything I need from them. Do not promise any date that is not in my notes.

My rough notes:
[paste your notes from the sales call]

What good output looks like. The client page is ready to save straight into 03_Clients with a few TODOs to fill. The task list includes at least one thing you had not thought of. The email sounds like you, because your MASTER file told it how you write.

Skill 3: Proposal Drafter

What it does. Turns a conversation with a prospect into a proposal you can edit and send.

When to use it. Same day as the meeting, when you are still clear on what they actually asked for.

Paste this:

You are my business assistant. Draft a proposal.

Below are my notes from the conversation, plus what I sell and what I charge. Write a proposal with these sections:

THE PROBLEM. Their situation in their own words from my notes. Do not soften it and do not add problems they did not mention.

WHAT WE WILL DO. The work itself, in plain terms, as bullets.

WHAT YOU GET. The outcome, not the activity.

WHAT IT COSTS. Use only prices from my notes. If a price is missing, write PRICE TBC rather than making one up.

WHAT IS NOT INCLUDED. Be specific here. This section prevents arguments later, so think about what a client could reasonably assume is included and rule it out.

TIMELINE AND NEXT STEP. One clear action for them to take.

Rules: no hype words, no filler. Under 600 words. Then, separately below the proposal, list anything I have not told you that I need to nail down before sending this.

My notes:
[paste the meeting note]

What I sell and charge:
[paste 01_Company pricing, or your MASTER file if the prices are in it]

What good output looks like. A draft you edit for twenty minutes rather than write from scratch for two hours. The "not included" section should name two or three things you would have forgotten. The list of gaps at the end is the most useful part, read it before you read the proposal.

Skill 4: Meeting Notes to Actions

What it does. Takes messy notes from a call and pulls out who owes what to whom by when.

When to use it. Within ten minutes of the call ending. Every time.

Paste this:

You are my business assistant. Below are my rough notes from a meeting. Turn them into a clean meeting note with these headings:

WHAT WAS DISCUSSED. Short bullets. What they said matters more than what I said.

DECISIONS MADE. Only actual decisions, not discussion.

ACTIONS. Format each one as: owner | what | by when.

If my notes do not say who owns it or when it is due, write UNASSIGNED or NO DATE rather than guessing. Put my own actions first.

OPEN QUESTIONS. Anything left hanging.

FOR NEXT TIME. Anything to remember before I speak to them again.

Rules: keep my meaning exactly. Fix my grammar and spelling. Add nothing I did not say. Output it as a markdown note I can save straight into my folder.

My rough notes:

[type or paste whatever you scribbled]

What good output looks like. Every promise made in the room appears in the actions list, including the vague ones, marked UNASSIGNED so you have to deal with them. Nothing appears that you did not say. Save the output into 06_Meetings with today's date in the filename and you are done.

Skill 5: Chase Email Drafter

What it does. Writes the awkward follow-up email you have been avoiding. Unpaid invoices, silent prospects, clients who owe you information.

When to use it. The moment you notice the silence, instead of three weeks later.

Paste this:

You are my business assistant. Draft a chase email.

Situation: [choose one and delete the rest]

- An invoice is unpaid
- A prospect has gone quiet after a good conversation
- A client owes me something I need to do my job

The facts:

- Who: [name and their role]
- What I am chasing: [invoice number and amount, or the thing they owe me]
- When it was due or when we last spoke: [date]
- How overdue: [number of days]
- History: [anything relevant, e.g. they have always paid on time]

Write the email. Rules:

- Under 100 words.
- Polite, direct, assumes good faith. No apologising for chasing.
- Never use the phrase "just checking in" or "circling back".
- One clear ask, with one clear thing they can reply with.
- Do not threaten anything or mention late payment charges unless I told you to.
- Include a subject line.

Then, underneath, write a second version that is one notch firmer, for if there is no reply in a week.

What good output looks like. Two emails. The first is short enough that you send it without editing. The second is firmer without being rude, and you have it ready so the follow-up actually happens.

Skill 6: Monthly Numbers Questions

What it does. Looks at your costs and admin facts and asks the questions you should be asking yourself.

When to use it. Once a month, when the card statements land.

Paste this:

You are a blunt finance-minded adviser. Below are my recurring costs and admin notes.

Give me four things.

ONE: a table with columns Item, Cost per month (convert any annual figures to monthly), and Keep or Question. Mark as Question anything that looks duplicated, unused based on my notes, or expensive for what it is.

TWO: the total monthly cost, and the total of everything you marked Question. Show your working for the annual conversions.

THREE: every date, deadline and renewal you can find in my notes, sorted earliest first, in the format DATE | what it is. Today is [type today's date]. Put SOON at the start of anything in the next 30 days.

FOUR: the five questions I should be able to answer about this business and probably cannot from these notes alone. Be specific to what you can see, not generic.

Do not invent any figure or date. If something is missing, say it is missing.

My notes:

[paste 04_Finance_Admin/Recurring_Costs.md and any other admin notes]

What good output looks like. A table you check the arithmetic on yourself, at least two subscriptions you had forgotten you pay for, and a renewal date you were about to be ambushed by. Section four is the one worth reading twice.

Skill 7: Decision Log Writer

What it does. Turns a decision you just made into a written record of why you made it.

When to use it. The same day you decide anything that costs money, changes direction, or you would struggle to explain in six months.

Paste this:

You are my business assistant. I have made a decision and I want it written down properly.

Turn my rough notes below into a decision record with these exact headings: What we decided, Why, What we said no to, What this commits us to.

Today's date is [type today's date].

Rules: keep my reasoning exactly as I gave it. Tidy the wording, add nothing. If I have not said what I rejected, write "not recorded" rather than inventing options. Output as a markdown note I can save.

Then, separately, ask me up to three questions whose answers would make this record more useful to read in a year's time.

My rough notes on the decision:
[type or paste what you decided and why]

What good output looks like. A short record you save into the project's DECISIONS folder in under a minute. The three questions at the end are the value. Answer them and paste them in.

Skill 8: SOP Writer

What it does. Takes something only you know how to do and turns it into steps someone else could follow.

When to use it. Once a month, pick one job that lives only in your head. Especially before you hire, go on holiday, or get ill.

Paste this:

You are my business assistant. Below is my rough description of how we do a job in this business.

Turn it into a numbered step-by-step procedure that a new starter could follow with no other help and nobody to ask.

Rules:

- Start with one line saying what this procedure is for and when it gets used.
- Number every step. One action per step.
- Where my description skips a step, is vague, or assumes knowledge I have not given you, insert a line that reads "CHECK: [what is unclear]" instead of guessing. Be picky about this, it is the point of the exercise.
- Name any tool, file or person needed at each step.
- End with a short "what good looks like" section and a "common mistakes" section based only on what I told you.

Output as a markdown note.

How we do it:

[describe the job roughly, as if talking someone through it on the phone]

What good output looks like. More CHECK lines than you expected. Those are the bits of the job that only exist in your head, which is exactly what you were trying to find. Answer them, re-run the skill, and file the result.

Skill 9: Meeting Brief

What it does. Ten minutes before a meeting, tells you everything you should walk in knowing.

When to use it. Before every client meeting. This is the one that makes people think you have a better memory than you do.

Paste this:

You are preparing me for a meeting. Below is my page on the person or company I am meeting, plus the note from our last conversation.

Give me a brief with exactly these headings:

WHO. Two lines. Name, role, what they buy from us.

WHERE THINGS STAND. Three bullets.

WHAT I PROMISED LAST TIME. Every commitment I made, and whether the notes show it was done. Be direct if something was not done.

WHAT THEY PROMISED. Same treatment.

LANDMINES. Anything sensitive, unresolved or awkward.

THREE QUESTIONS TO ASK. Specific to them, not generic.

Rules: under 250 words. Only use my notes. If something important is obviously missing from my notes, say so at the end in one line.

My notes:

[paste the client page from 03_Clients and the last meeting note]

What good output looks like. Something you can read in ninety seconds on the way into the meeting. The "what I promised" section should occasionally catch you out, which is the whole reason it is in there.

Making your own skills

When you write an instruction that works, save it in 05_Skills with one line on when to use it. That is how the set grows.

Every skill above is built from the same five parts. Copy the pattern.

1. **Role.** "You are my business assistant." Or sharper when you need it: "You are a blunt adviser."
2. **Input.** Say exactly what you are giving it, then give it.
3. **Job.** One job. If you want two things, write two skills.
4. **Format.** The exact headings and limits you want back. This is what makes the output consistent rather than a wall of prose.
5. **Guardrail.** "Only use my notes. Do not invent anything. Say so if it is not there."

Five parts, every time. That is the whole craft, and now you have it.

Do this now

Open ChatGPT or Claude, create a project, and paste your MASTER file into the instructions box. Then start a chat, paste Skill 4 (Meeting Notes to Actions), and run it on the notes from your last call, even if those notes are three scrappy lines on your phone. Five minutes, and you will see the point immediately.

Running It Weekly

Two minutes a day, twenty minutes a week, an hour a month. The habit that decides whether this still works in six months.

Here is the honest bit. The folder and the skills are the easy part. You have done those in half an hour.

What decides whether this is still working next March is whether you write things down. Not lots. A little, often, at the same times. This file is that routine.

Everything here fits inside the time you already spend being disorganised.

The three habits

When	How long	What you do
End of each working day	2 minutes	Capture what happened
Friday, same slot every week	20 minutes	Run the Weekly Review, look at clients and projects
First working day of the month	1 hour	Numbers, one procedure written down, one tidy-up

Three habits. If you only ever manage one, make it the daily two minutes, because the other two are worthless without it.

Daily: two minutes

At the end of the day, before you shut the laptop, open Obsidian and write down what happened. That is it.

You are answering four things, in bullets, badly:

- What did I do
- What did I decide
- Who owes me something
- What are the top three for tomorrow

Rough is fine. Fragments are fine. Spelling is irrelevant. Nobody is reading this except you and the AI, and the AI will tidy it whenever you need it tidy.

Where things go, if you want to be neat about it:

Where things go

If it was about	It goes in
A client	03_Clients update their page
A project	02_Active_Projects update TASKS
A meeting or call	06_Meetings new dated note
Money or admin	04_Finance_Admin
A decision	DECISIONS folder one file per decision

In Obsidian this is drawn as a diagram. Here it is as a table, which says the same thing.

(In Obsidian this draws itself as a diagram. Or ignore it, it is only a picture of the paragraph above.)

Two rules make the two minutes work.

Rough beats late. Three bullets today beat a beautiful write-up on Sunday that never happens. If you had a call and typed nothing, type three words now.

Same day, always. A meeting note written on Friday about Tuesday's meeting is fiction. You will confidently write down things that did not happen.

If you had a proper call, this is where you run Skill 4 (Meeting Notes to Actions) on your scrappy notes. Ninety seconds, and you get a clean note plus every promise anyone made.

Weekly: twenty minutes

Same slot every week. Friday afternoon works well, because the week is finished and Monday arrives with a plan already written. Put it in your calendar as a recurring event or it will not happen.

Minutes 0 to 5: run the Weekly Review.

Open your project chat, paste Skill 1, and paste in the week's notes from 06_Meetings. Read what comes back, especially the dropped balls.

Minutes 5 to 12: look at your clients.

Open your two or three most important client pages. For each one, ask yourself one question: when did I last speak to them, and does that feel too long? Update the "Where things stand" section on each page while you are in there.

If one of them feels like it is going quiet, that is the signal. Do something about it today, not next month.

Minutes 12 to 17: look at your projects.

Open each active project's TASKS.md. Anything that has been in the "Now" section for three weeks is not a task, it is a problem. Either do it, break it into something smaller, or admit it is not happening and delete it.

Anything sitting in "Waiting on" for more than a week gets Skill 5 (Chase Email Drafter) run on it, right now, before you move on.

Minutes 17 to 20: write next week down.

Three priorities for next week, in a note. Hardest first. Then anything that finished this week gets moved to 99_Archive.

That last move matters more than it looks. A folder where everything visible is live is a folder you can trust at a glance. A folder full of dead projects is one you start avoiding.

Monthly: one hour

First working day of the month. This is the hour that stops the slow rot.

Minutes 0 to 15: the numbers.

Run Skill 6 (Monthly Numbers Questions) on your 04_Finance_Admin notes. Check its arithmetic yourself. Cancel one thing you are paying for and not using. There is almost always one.

Diarise anything it flagged as coming up in the next 30 days.

Minutes 15 to 35: get one job out of your head.

Pick one thing that only you know how to do and run Skill 8 (SOP Writer) on it. Answer the CHECK questions it throws back. Save it in 00_System or the relevant project folder.

Twelve months of this and you have twelve written procedures, which is the difference between a business and a job you cannot leave.

Minutes 35 to 50: update the MASTER file.

Open 00_System/MASTER.md and reread it. Most of it will still be true. The section that will be out of date is "What is going on right now": the quarter's goal, the biggest problem, what you are worried about.

Update that section. Then paste the new version into your ChatGPT or Claude project instructions, replacing the old one. This is a two-minute job that keeps every answer you get for the next month accurate rather than six months stale.

Minutes 50 to 60: tidy.

Archive finished projects. Move former clients to 99_Archive. Delete nothing.

Look at anything you have written this month that has no home and give it one.

What it looks like after three months

Month one feels like admin. You are writing into a folder that is not yet answering you back, and it takes discipline.

Month two, the skills start returning things you did not know. The Weekly Review names a client you had not thought about in five weeks. The Meeting Brief reminds you of something you promised in March.

Month three, you stop reconstructing. You do not spend Monday morning working out where you were. You do not lose an afternoon looking for what you charged someone eighteen months ago. When a client rings out of nowhere, you open one page and you are ready in ninety seconds.

That is the whole return. It is not dramatic and it does not arrive in week one, which is exactly why most people never get it.

When you fall off

You will. Everyone does, usually around a busy fortnight.

Do not try to reconstruct the missing weeks. It will be wrong and you will resent it. Just start again on the next working day and write down today. The folder does not care about the gap and neither should you.

The only version of this that fails is the one you abandon because you feel behind.

Do this now

Open your calendar. Put a recurring twenty minute event in for Friday afternoon called "Weekly Review". Then open Obsidian and write today's three bullets, even if today was quiet. The habit starts with today, not Monday.

When Your Data Cannot Leave

The day cloud AI stops being fine, what your options actually are, and how much they cost.

Everything in this kit so far sends your text to ChatGPT or Claude. For most work, most of the time, that is fine. Both companies are serious about security, both offer business terms, and the alternative for most small businesses is a filing system nobody can search.

But there is a day when it stops being fine, and it is better to know what that day looks like before it arrives.

How you will know

It is usually one of these.

A client asks in writing. "Do you use AI tools to process our information, and if so, which ones and where is the data held?" This question is now standard in supplier forms, and it is going to get more common, not less.

You sign something that says you cannot. An NDA with a clause about third-party processing. A contract that names approved subcontractors. A data agreement you skim-read that turns out to cover exactly this.

Your sector has rules. Legal, medical, financial advice, anything involving children, anything holding case files. In these fields the question is not whether it is technically safe, it is whether you can put it in writing that it never left.

Your own gut. You go to paste something in and you hesitate. That hesitation is information. It is usually correct.

Any one of those, and the honest answer is that this specific work needs a different setup. Not all your work. That specific work.

What is actually true about the cloud option

Before you panic and rip everything out, get the facts straight.

Paid business plans from the major AI companies do not use your conversations to train their models. That is in their terms and it is a meaningful commitment. They are almost certainly more secure than your email is.

What you cannot say, and what a serious client is really asking, is that the information never left your building. It did. It went to a data centre owned by someone else, under terms that can change, in a country you may not have chosen. For most work that is an acceptable trade. For some work it is not, and no amount of reassurance changes it.

So the question is not "is the cloud safe". It is "can I put in writing that this particular client's information never left my control". Sometimes you need to be able to say yes.

Option one: keep it out

The cheapest answer and the one people skip.

Some work simply does not go through AI. You do it the old way, and you write down which categories those are. One line in your MASTER file: "Client files for X and Y never go into any AI tool."

If you can do that without much pain, do that. It costs nothing and it is completely defensible.

Option two: run the AI on your own computer

You can download an AI model onto your own machine and run it with no internet connection at all. Genuinely none. Turn the wifi off and it still answers. Nothing you type ever leaves the room.

This is real, it is free, and a reasonably modern computer can do it. It is also more work than installing an app, and the answers are not as sharp as ChatGPT. Both of those things are true at the same time, and anyone who tells you otherwise is selling something.

What you need. A Mac from 2020 or later with an Apple chip, or a Windows machine with a decent graphics card. 16GB of memory is comfortable, 8GB works but slowly. About 10GB of free disk space.

How you do it. Install a free app called Ollama from ollama.com. Open it. Then open Terminal and run these two lines:

Type this into Terminal

```
ollama pull llama3.1:8b
ollama run llama3.1:8b
```

The first line downloads the model, which takes a few minutes and only ever happens once. The second starts a chat. Type a question, press return, and you have a private AI running on your own machine.

To use it on your files, copy a page out of Obsidian and paste it into that chat with one of the skills from this kit above it. That is the whole workflow. It is the same as everything you have learned, with a different window.

What you should expect. Slower answers. Less polish. It is good at summarising notes you give it, pulling actions out of meeting notes, and first drafts. It is weaker at anything long, subtle, or requiring several steps of reasoning. Treat what it says as a sharp first draft, never as final, and check anything involving money or a promise to a client.

Two things that will catch you out. It can only hold so much text at once, so give it one page at a time rather than your whole folder. And check what your backup software is doing, because a private setup with your folder syncing to a cloud drive is not private.

If you are comfortable with the two lines above, this route costs you nothing but an afternoon. Plenty of people stop here and never need anything else.

Option three: have it done for you

If the above sounds like a weekend you do not have, or the stakes are high enough that "I set it up myself and I think it is fine" is not an answer you want to give a client, this is what we do at Heoka.

We install a private AI setup on hardware in your office. Your files, your building, no internet needed for it to work. Your staff use it like any other chat window. Nothing goes out.

The starting point is a £500 audit. Half a day. We look at what information you actually hold, which of it genuinely cannot leave, what your clients and contracts require of you, and whether a private setup is worth the money in your case.

You get a written report either way. Sometimes that report says you do not need us, and if it does, we say so, because the alternative is selling you a machine you will resent in six months.

If it does make sense, the report tells you what it would cost and what it would do. No obligation attached to it.

Book here: <https://calendar.app.google/C2fbqws67vmDvneV7>

If you are not there yet, that is completely fine. Most people using this kit are not. Keep the link. The day a client sends you that question in writing, you will want to have already had the conversation.

Do this now

Open 00_System/MASTER.md and add one line under the rules section: which of your clients or which categories of your work should never go into a cloud AI tool. Even if the answer is "none of it, for now". Writing it down is the point. It takes two minutes and it means the decision is made before the pressure arrives.